

New *P'ansori* in Twenty-first-century Korea: Creative Dialectics of Tradition and Modernity

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Nearly a century has passed since the first new p'ansori piece The Song of Ch'oe Pyōng-du was performed at the turn of the twentieth century. While traditional p'ansori, a form of folk musical drama, came to symbolize the cultural and artistic heritage of the Korean nation, new p'ansori, in new millennium, aspires to be a cultural expression that is relevant to the contemporary conditions of everyday life while retaining or even restoring what is considered to be the quintessential p'ansori aesthetics. This article explores the ways in which new p'ansori combines various elements of tradition and modernity in its text, music, and performance style, which, in turn, lead to the polemics of p'ansori aesthetics and the authenticity debate.

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The turn of the new millennium has seen a proliferation of newly created works in Korean performing arts that bring together traditional mediums and modern expressions.¹ Among them is new *p'ansori* (*ch'angjak p'ansori*, literally “newly created *p'ansori*”) and it is growing fast as an art form that appeals to a wide range of audiences.² Although new *p'ansori* pieces have been produced since the beginning

of the twentieth century, the production and consumption patterns of this genre since the turn of the millennium involve very different processes and dynamics shaped by changing socioeconomic environment and aesthetic preferences as well as increasing influences of technology such as the Internet. A close examination of this art form in these current contexts sheds a light on the emergence of new sensibilities toward tradition, modernity, and creativity in twenty-first-century Korea. However, before exploring these developments in some depth, it is necessary to briefly describe the history, text, music, and performance of *p'ansori* to create a base from which comparisons can be made.³

What Is *P'ansori*? Historical Origins and Contemporary Fusion

P'ansori is a form of traditional musical drama that has been developed by professional folk musicians or *kwangdae* since the beginning of the eighteenth century. The prefix “*p'an-*” refers to a place where people gather together, and the suffix “*-sori*” means sound and refers to the singing voice or song in this context. *P'ansori* used to be performed in an open space, such as a marketplace or courtyard, along with other entertainments, for example, acrobats, tumblers, and clowns, or in the sitting room of a wealthy patron. *P'ansori* became an independent form of entertainment in the mid nineteenth century, and from the turn of the twentieth century was brought onto the stage in concert halls and auditoriums with lights and amplification.

In performance, the *p'ansori* singer, wearing a traditional Korean costume, delivers a dramatic story through songs (*sori*), dialogue or narration (*aniri*), and gesture (*pallim*) using the symbolic props of a fan and handkerchief in his or her hand. Most performances begin with an introductory song, *tan'ga* (literally, “short song”), to warm up the voice. Each song in *p'ansori* is assigned to a particular *cho* (mode) and *changdan* (rhythmic cycle), and a particular combination of *cho* and *changdan* is associated with a particular mood, character, or action in the story (see Um 1993b).⁴ A drummer (*kosu*), who also wears traditional costume, accompanies the singer with a barrel drum (*puk*) by playing *changdan* assigned to each song, although he may improvise on the basic rhythmic pattern in sympathy with the textual and melodic context.⁵ Both the drummer and audience make calls of encouragement or *ch'uimsae* at appropriate phrase endings.

Many Korean scholars attribute the origins of *p'ansori* to a blend of the shamanist chants from the southwestern province of Chôlla and the folk entertainment for the lower classes of the period. Legends, folk tales, popular novels, and classical poems also made a contribution to the themes and style of *p'ansori* narratives to build a multilayer of

intertextuality or network of textual relations. From the original repertoire of twelve *p'ansori* pieces, established by the turn of the nineteenth century, only five of them have been transmitted through various *p'ansori* schools to the present day. They include: *The Song of Ch'unhyang* (*Ch'unhyang-ga*), *The Song of Simch'ŏng* (*Simch'ŏng-ga*), *The Song of Hŭngbo* (*Hŭngbo-ga*), *The Song of the Underwater Palace* (*Sugung-ga*), and *The Song of The Red Cliff* (*Chŏkpyŏk-ka*). The decrease of the *p'ansori* repertoire can be attributed to the influences of the upper-class patrons of the nineteenth century who exercised considerable control over the text and repertoire; while the literary refinement of the *p'ansori* texts is indebted to these gentlemen scholars, their preoccupation with Confucian morality and ideology rejected those *p'ansori* pieces with “obscene and inappropriate” themes (Um 1993a). It is therefore not surprising that the main themes of the remaining five *p'ansori* pieces coincide with the five cardinal principles of Confucian ethics.

Traditional *p'ansori* was designated as an Intangible Cultural Asset by the Korean Ministry of Culture in 1964 and was also proclaimed as one of the UNESCO Masterpieces of Oral and Intangible Heritage of Humanity in 2003.⁶ While *p'ansori* is often presented to audiences abroad as the very essence of Korean cultural and artistic heritage, some *p'ansori* singers have collaborated with artists from other musical cultures to produce a “fusion” of world musics. For example, An Suk-sŏn (b. 1949) performed with Japanese, American, and European jazz musicians in the 1990s and took part in the production of several recordings.⁷ More recently, another *p'ansori* singer, Yi Charam (b. 1979), collaborated with the Korean hip-hop artist OneSun in 2001.⁸

How “New” Is New *P'ansori*?

New *p'ansori* refers to *p'ansori* created since the beginning of the twentieth century, which marked the end of traditional society, the advent of modernity, and the encroachment of Japanese colonialism in Korea. Artistically speaking, the turn of the twentieth century heralded the era of new genres such as the instrumental *sanjo* solo, the vocal and instrumental *kayagŭm pyŏngch'ang* duet, and the large-cast *p'ansori* theatre, *ch'anggŭk*.⁹

The very first piece of new *p'ansori* was *The Song of Ch'oe Pyŏng-du* (*Ch'oe Pyŏng-du T'aryŏng*), created by the singer Kim Ch'ang-hwan (1854–1927) in 1904. This work was based on a real event in which a farmer named Ch'oe Pyŏng-du was wrongly persecuted by a corrupt government official in Kangwŏn Province. Another singer, Kang Yonghwan (1865–1938), later made *The Song of Ch'oe Pyŏng-du* into a *p'ansori* theatre presentation (*ch'anggŭk*). In 1908 Yi In-jik adapted the same

story as a play titled *The Silver World* (*Ŭnsegŷe*), which was the first modern Korean theatre production (Yu 1990:16). However, neither the *p'ansori* version nor the *ch'anggŭk* adaptation of *The Song of Ch'oe Pyŏngdu* has been passed down to the present day performance practice.

It was after the Japanese occupation of Korea (1910–1945) that new *p'ansori* began to flourish. In many ways, new *p'ansori* of the twentieth century is a postcolonial creation that can be grouped into three types: patriotic *p'ansori* (*yŏlsaga*), religious *p'ansori*, and sociopolitical *p'ansori*. Each type, in turn, owes its development to a different combination of musical heritage, artistic aims, social class, and patronage. All three types of new *p'ansori*, however, express a strong nationalist sentiment irrespective of their association with anticolonial, postcolonial, religious, or cultural aspirations.

Patriotic *P'ansori*

Shortly after the liberation from Japanese occupation in 1945, Pak Tong-sil (1897–1968) created new *p'ansori* pieces with nationalist and anti-Japanese themes, known as *yŏlsaga* (literally, the song of the patriot).¹⁰ Four pieces of Pak Tong-sil's patriotic new *p'ansori* depict acts of resistance against Japanese colonialism by Yi Chun, An Chung-gŭn, Yun Pong-gil, and Yu Kwan-sun.¹¹ This type of new *p'ansori* with nationalist vigor was very popular during the postliberation period, and some other *p'ansori* artists created their own *yŏlsaga* pieces, for example, *The Tale of Yi Sun-sin* (*Yi Sun-sin-jŏn*), composed by Kim Yŏn-su (1907–1974). But at the same time, many singers in South Korea were reluctant to perform Pak Tong-sil's compositions after Pak's defection to the communist North Korea in the early 1950s. It was only in 1993 that Yi Sŏng-gŭn (b. 1935) and Chŏng Sun-im (b. 1942) made a recording of Pak Tong-sil's compositions.¹² Since the 1970s Chŏng Ch'ŏl-ho (b. 1923) has also created a number of patriotic *p'ansori* pieces, and some of his works were released on audio compact discs in 2001.¹³

Patriotic *p'ansori*, which was developed by professional singers with traditional training, closely follows the stylistic idioms of conventional *p'ansori* with respect to its musical and textual organization. In fact, most of the patriotic *p'ansori* composers were also involved with *ch'anggŭk* (*p'ansori* theatre), using their creative talent to adapt *p'ansori* tradition into a new form of theatrical production.

Religious *P'ansori*

In the 1970s new *p'ansori* started to be associated with religious topics. Given the fact that the origins of *p'ansori* are linked to the shamanist ritual music of southwest Korea, it is not surprising that religion also provides a thematic resource for this genre. Pak Tong-jin (1916–

2003) sang the first *p'ansori* with Christian themes or “Bible *p'ansori*” (*sōnggyōng p'ansori*) in 1970. This composition, titled *The Tale of Jesus* (*Yesu-jōn*), was based on the New Testament book of Matthew and was written by the playwright Chu T'ae-ik. Other *p'ansori* singers also began to create new compositions with Christian themes. For example, in 1985 Yi Yong-bae performed *The Tale of Saint Andrea Kim Taegōn* (*Sōng Andrea Kim Taegōn*) commissioned by the Roman Catholic Church in Korea. This piece describes the life and martyrdom of the first Korean born Catholic priest Kim Tae-gōn.¹⁴

Religious *p'ansori* also took Buddhism as its theme. For example, in 1988 Cho Sang-hyōn (b. 1939) performed *The Drum Sound of Creation* (*Kaebōk ūi Puksori*), which was commissioned by the Won Buddhist sect for the celebration the one-hundredth anniversary of the birth of their founder.¹⁵ Yi Yong-bae's 1997 performance of *The Life of High Priest Samyōng* (*Samyōng Taesa Iltaegi*) depicts the religious and political activities of the Korean Buddhist priest Yujōng (1544–1610), who led the Buddhist monk militia against the Japanese invasion in the sixteenth century. Since the mid 1990s An Suk-sōn (b. 1949), who is also a devout Buddhist, began to create Buddhist chants in the style of *p'ansori*, and in 1999 she gave a performance of *The Tale of Buddha* (*Pult'a-jōn*).¹⁶

Religious *p'ansori* shares many common characteristics with patriotic *p'ansori*. Having been developed by professional singers, it closely follows the traditional *p'ansori* style. It often depicts historical figures and events that are closely associated with nationalist and anti-colonial struggle, therefore merging religion with national politics. Religious *p'ansori* is usually commissioned by a church or monastery, which seeks to bring traditional Korean cultural elements into their service and events. Subsequently, the creation and reception of these new *p'ansori* works tend to remain within the domain of these religious institutions and their followers.

Sociopolitical *P'ansori*

Another type of new *p'ansori* developed since the 1970s concern themselves with the political and social issues of contemporary Korea. Unlike the other two new *p'ansori* types, sociopolitical *p'ansori* was developed mainly by nonprofessional or semiprofessional singers, who combine basic elements of traditional *p'ansori* with contemporary Korean literature. In this genre, both artists and audiences, who tend to be of the young urban middle class, consider this musical form as a vehicle for social and ideological commentary. Im Chin-t'aek (b. 1950) was the first artist to create new *p'ansori* pieces of this kind based on the highly political literary works of Kim Chi-ha (b. 1941).¹⁷ Im Chin-t'aek began his new *p'ansori* creation in 1974 when he gave his first public perfor-

mance of *The History of a Sound* (*Sori Naeryŏk*) in Myŏngdong Cathedral in Seoul.¹⁸ His famous and most controversial work was *The Sea of Excrement* (*Ttongbada*) performed in 1985, followed by another piece, *The Five Bandits* (*Ojŏk*), in 1993.¹⁹ Although he was subject to pressure and censorship from the dictatorial regime of President Pak Ch'ŏng-hŭi²⁰ and his successor Chŏn Tu-hwan, Im Chin-t'aek and his drummer Yi Kyu-ho continued to give numerous underground performance in the 1980s. Im Chin-t'aek's new *p'ansori* music with Kim Chi-ha's literary works came to symbolize the nationalist movement and political resistance against these dictatorial regimes of the period. Another example of Im Chin-t'aek's work is *May in Kwangju* (*Owŏl Kwangju*), written in 1994, which is based on the political civil uprising in Kwangju, south Chŏlla Province in May 1980. Chŏng Ch'ŏl-ho also composed a musical drama version of the same event titled *The Day to Remember* (*Kŭnariyŏ Yŏngwŏnhara*).²¹

Compositional Process and Creative Techniques in New *P'ansori*

The compositional process in new *p'ansori* is generally in two stages: the text is usually written first, and then the music is arranged accordingly, although the text may then need some adjustment. The text may be newly written or taken from a source other than that of traditional *p'ansori*.²² However, the music tends to be arranged and/or improvised with a strong basis in the conventional musical styles and idioms of traditional *p'ansori*, such as vocal techniques, rhythms (*changdan*), and mode (*cho*). During this process of combining the various textual and musical components together, *p'ansori* singers often use a tape recorder in place of musical notations, this being their normal teaching method.

The themes and textual materials featured in the new *p'ansori* of the twentieth century all tend to have sombre overtones. The patriotic *p'ansori* depicts the anti-Japanese movement that leads to the martyrdom of the protagonists. These nationalistic new *p'ansori* pieces of the postcolonial era tend to idealize the protagonists and their deeds in such ways that some fictitious events and details are added to the stories for dramatic effect and embellishment. For example, Pak Tong-sil's *The Song of Yi Chun* (*Yi Chun Yŏlsaga*) ends with the dramatic suicide of the hero in which he stabs his own chest and sprays his own blood on the face of the Japanese delegates at the Hague Peace Convention. In reality, however, Yi Chun died in the Hague from an illness, which was brought on by a facial abscess. In this dramatic climax, the fast *chajinmori* rhythm (12/8) and sorrowful *kyemyŏnjo* mode are employed performed by singer Yi Sŏng-gŭn in this excerpt from *The Song of Yi Chun*:

Venerable Yi Chun in his rage,
 Feels his hair stand on end,
 His boiling blood fills up to his chin,
 His fury soars to the sky.
 Rushing to the front of the meeting, [he says]
 “You, wretched Japanese!
 Your aggressor nation threatened and violated Korea.
 Now you deceive these ambassadors of the world,
 Our Korea is the country of courteous people in the East.
 You deceitful people should be ashamed of yourselves before heaven.
 You should see this loyal blood of the brave nation of five
 thousands-years history!”
 He quickly pulls the dagger out of his jacket,
 Stabs his chest through
 And is drenched in his own blood.
 He sprays the blood onto the face of the Japanese delegates,
 [and says]
 “You, wretched Japanese!”
 Gritting his teeth,
 He takes out a Korean flag and shouts three times,
 “Long Live Korea, Long Live Korea, Long Live Korea!”
 Then his last signs of life gradually fade away. . . . (*Ch’angjak P’ansori*
Yōlsaga 1993: CD 1, Track 1 [*The Song of Yi Chun*, performed by
 Yi Sōng-gŭn])

The sociopolitical *p’ansori* pieces composed and performed by Im Chin-t’aek are often better known by Kim Chi-ha’s literary work. In fact, the two audio compact discs produced in 1994 are both titled *Kim Chi-ha’s New P’ansori* (*Kim Chi-ha Ch’angjak P’ansori*) (see discography). Kim Chi-ha’s narrative poems (*tamsi*) closely follow the structure, rhythms, and literary techniques of traditional *p’ansori*. For example, *The Five Bandits* (*Ojōk*), written in 1970, mixes tragedy with humor in its political irony and satire. It also exploits various *p’ansori* rhetorical devices such as rhymes, epiphora, asyndeton, onomatopoeia, mimesis, and metaphor.²³ However, the language and vocabulary are predominantly contemporary, whereas traditional *p’ansori* uses an archaic form of Korean. The five bandits in this poem refer to Korea’s financial conglomerates, members of parliament, high-ranking government officials, military generals, and cabinet ministers. At the same time this title also makes reference to “the five bandits” who colluded with the Japanese imperialists and “sold out” Korea to them at the beginning of the twentieth century, thereby creating several layers of intertextuality at the sociopolitical and historical levels.

The excerpt below describes the first bandit, a rich financier. The singer Im Chin-t’aek chose the moderately fast *chungjungmori*

rhythm (12/8) and the *söllŏngje* melodic type, which, in traditional *p'ansori*, is normally associated with a scene where a man marches in a vigorous or pompous manner.

There the first bandit *is coming*,
 It is that wretched financial conglomerate who *is coming*.
 He *wears* a cloth that is made of *money*,
 He *wears* a hat made of *money*,
 He *wears* a pair of shoes made of *money*,
 He *wears* a pair gloves made of *money*,
 He *wears* a *gold* watch, *gold* ring, *gold* bracelet, *gold* buttons, *gold*
 tiepin, *gold* cuff links, *gold* buckle, *gold* teeth, *gold* fingernails,
gold toenails, *gold* zipper, and *gold* watch chain.
 With his wobbly rump and bulging belly,
 He keeps farting and waddling,
 There he *is coming*.
 Let's see what his talent is,
 Let's see what this wretched financial conglomerate's talent is.
 He roasts the cabinet minister golden brown.
 He boils the deputy minister deep red.
 He adds some vinegar, soy sauce, mustard, chilli paste, and a pinch
 of MSG,
 Together with some shredded red peppers, spring onions, and garlic,
 He then eats them up.
 He takes bank loans, foreign loans, all sorts of benefits and privileges,
 He then gulps them down.
 He takes many mistresses
 And keeps himself busy day and night making many kids.
 He makes all his daughters the rulers' mistresses
 By offering them as night snacks,
 So that he gets inside tip-offs.
 He then makes bids in his favour,
 Buys lands for nothing
 And makes a fortune when the roads are built through them.
 His thousands of won building contract cost only five won,
 But the labourers' wage is all on credit, nothing but credit.
 His talent for scheming outshines that of the Monkey King and
 His talent for persuasion [*kuwŏsamta*, literally roasting and boiling]
 outrival that of a Chinese chef. (*Kim Chi-ha Ch'angjak P'ansori* 1 1994:
 Track 1 [*The Five Bandits*, performed by Im Chin-t'aek])

New *P'ansori* of the New Millennium

How different is new *p'ansori* of the twenty-first century from its predecessors? Although new *p'ansori* in the new millennium maintains its roots to traditional *p'ansori*, it has introduced many new influences

to its text and music, production and consumption of performance, agents and contexts as follows.

Text and Music

With regard to the themes and textual materials employed, the historical, religious, and sociopolitical issues that prevailed in the twentieth century continue to be important in the twenty-first century.²⁴ However, a much wider range of topics has been introduced, and they include everyday life and personal and social problems that are relevant to different generations and individuals, for example, the exam pressures on school children, the impact of urban migration on rural young males, economic recession, elderly people's fear of Alzheimer's disease, feminist issues,²⁵ environmental pollution, etc. Additionally, various elements of Korean and Western popular culture—such as pop songs, computer and card games, cartoons, and science fiction—are introduced as musical and textual materials. Although nationalist sentiment has not disappeared all together, ubiquitous patriotism and anti-Japanese sentiment prevalent in the twentieth century new *p'ansori* have now given way to a gentler form of cultural nationalism and cosmopolitan attitudes.

Another characteristic that distinguishes twenty-first-century new *p'ansori* from its predecessor is that humor is greatly emphasized, in contrast to the somber, serious, and even tragic new *p'ansori* of the twentieth century. For example, Yi Tök-in's satirical comedy *Father's Fine* (*Appa ūi Pōlgŭm*) is based on a real event and character. It tells us about an unfortunate manual laborer, named Yi U-yŏn, who was jailed when he failed to pay off his disproportionately accumulated fine.²⁶ Although it makes a critique of social injustice, resonating with the theme of the very first new *p'ansori* piece of the last century (*The Song of Ch'oe Pyŏng-du*), it handles the topic with humor and irony. Another example is Kim Myŏng-ja's popular new *p'ansori* piece *Mrs. Super's Wrestling Match* (*Sup'ōtaek Ssirūm Taehoe Ch'ulchōngi*), which is a comical caricature of a working-class housewife and corner shopkeeper who covets winning a refrigerator designed for Korean *kimch'i* pickles at the all-women wrestling contest.

Some new *p'ansori* pieces are also especially created for younger audiences and performers. For example, some traditional Korean children's stories, such as *The Rabbit and Turtle* (*T'okki wa Kōbugi*) and *The Sun and the Moon* (*Haennim Tallim*) are made into new *p'ansori* pieces with modern interpretations and contemporary comical twists.²⁷ *Chaemine Village* (*Chaemine Kol*) is another didactic new *p'ansori* piece based on a folktale created for young audiences.²⁸ Cartoons and comic books also contribute to new *p'ansori* for children. For example, *Tuli, the Baby*

Dinosaur (*Agi Kongnyong Tuli*), is based on the popular Korean cartoon from the 1980s and can be sung by a young *p'ansori* singer.²⁹ More recently, new *p'ansori* pieces, which are also based on folktales and legends, are, in turn, made into digital animations, such as *Ani P'ansori* (2005), in which preteen and teenage *p'ansori* singers provide the vocal parts (see discography).

The language used in twenty-first-century *p'ansori* is very much closer to contemporary colloquial Korean. Although the Chŏlla dialect is still predominant, other regional dialects are sometimes employed depending on the dramatic situation and characters depicted. In fact, the linguistic parameter of traditional *p'ansori*, that included an archaic Chŏlla dialect and Sino-Korean words from classical Chinese and Korean literature, has now been replaced by various regional dialects, speech styles including slang and sometimes even Japanese and English words.

For example, in the following excerpt from *Tuli the Baby Dinosaur*, which is composed for children and performed by a young *p'ansori* singer, the preteen speech style and intonation with the Seoul accent is used.

PROLOGUE: One day, an iceberg from the South Pole arrived in the middle of Seoul. Since then, there has not been a single quiet moment in Kiltong's house. Do you know why? It's all because of Tuli, that cheeky baby dinosaur who came out of the iceberg. Now I will tell you all about him and please listen to me.

SONG: (*moderately fast chungjungmori; cheerful p'yŏngjo mode in lines one and two, sorrowful kyemyŏnjo mode for line three and cheerful p'yŏnjo mode in lines four and five*)

With his big eyes, round nose, round tummy, and short legs,
He is so cute, warm-hearted, sweet, and always happy.
He cried sometime because he missed his Mom so much.
But he is not sad anymore because he decided to go and look
for her.

He will go to the far away planets to look for his Mom. (*Ch'angjak P'ansori Tasŏt Pat'angjŏn* 2004: Track 1, [*Tuli, the Baby Dinosaur*, performed by Kim Hae-ram])

The Song of an Old Bachelor (*Noch'onggak Kŏsigiga*) also illustrates this linguistic shift in twenty-first-century new *p'ansori*. It is a story about a bachelor from a rural area who comes to Seoul in search of his future bride because all the young eligible women left their village for a better life in the city. This *p'ansori* piece employs several different dialects and speech styles: the Chŏlla dialect for the narrator of this story and

the protagonist, the female speech style with the Seoul accent for the sleek city women who turn him down, and the Yanbian Korean dialect for the Chinese Korean seamstress whom the protagonist marries in the end. This migrant worker from the Yanbian Korean Autonomous Prefecture in northeast China is also depicted in the northern folksong style to indicate the region from which the ethnic Koreans in China originally emigrated in the mid nineteenth century. This type of musical borrowing to signify different regional and cultural identities is a technique used in traditional *p'ansori*. However, this is the first time that a topic like the impact of local and transnational migration on social and cultural demography has been introduced into the *p'ansori* repertoire.³⁰

Costume and Performance Style

The singer of new *p'ansori* is no longer restricted to the traditional costume. They can perform in modern clothes—Im Chin-t'aek was the first one to do this in the 1980s—or they can wear a costume specially designed for the piece. In fact, visual effects, created by special costumes and props, and theatrical acting have become an increasingly important element for new *p'ansori*. For example, when performing *Star Wars* (*Sta Taejŏn*), based on a computer game called StarCraft, Pak T'ae-o wears a long black coat and sunglasses and holds a baton, in the style of Darth Vader-cum-Terminator from the American sci-fi movies (see Figure 1). In another new *p'ansori* piece *Space Detective Chabûri, the Catcher* (*Uju T'amjŏng Chabûri*), which deals with the environment and waste problem, Sŏ Mi-hwa wears a sci-fi cartoon-inspired costume including a helmet, jump suit, cape, and goggles (see Figure 2).

The various new *p'ansori* themes are derived from urban, popular, translocal, and transnational cultures. The resultant literary, musical, and visual representations produce new intertextuality in which parody, satire, and irony can be fully understood through the dialectics of tradition and modernity at both local and global levels. For example, in the case of *Star Wars*, there are juxtapositions between the rules of the game set by the StarCraft computer software and the battle scene from the traditional *p'ansori* story *The Tale of The Red Cliff*, which, in turn is based on a Chinese historical novel. The costume and props used by the singer, Pak T'ae-o, bridge the function of the traditional *p'ansori* costumes, which normally include a long formal overcoat (*turumagi*) and a folding fan for the male singer, with the visual and character images of Darth Vader and the Terminator from the American sci-fi films.

A poster for a new *p'ansori* contest visually reiterates this intertextuality. The caricatures combine the face of individual performer/



FIGURE 1. *Star Wars* performed by Pak T'ae-o at the 2003 Chŏnju Sanjo Festival. (Photo: Courtesy of Ōlssigu Ttorang Kwangdae [Bravo Ttorang Kwangdae] website, <http://cafe.daum.net/NewAgePansori>)



FIGURE 2. *Space Detective the Catcher* performed by Sŏ Mi-hwa at the 2003 Chŏnju Sanjo Festival. (Photo: Courtesy of Ttorang Kwangdae website, <http://www.dorang.org>)

creators with familiar images associated with popular and traditional culture to illustrate the particular themes used in different new *p'ansori* pieces (see Figure 3): Ch'oe Yong-sŏk's anti-war *p'ansori*, *The Song of Smart Bomb* (*Smat P'oktan-ga*) (top left); Kim Myŏng-ja's comical *Mrs Super's Wrestling Match* (top right); Pak T'ae-o's sci-fi- and computer game-inspired *Star Wars* (middle left); Chŏng Tae-o's *The New Tale of Pyŏngangsoe* (*Sin Pyŏngangsoe-jŏn*), based on a traditional *p'ansori* story of an anti-hero (middle right); and Chŏng Yu-suk's satirical *The Blind Owl* (*Nunmŏn Puŏngi*) (bottom left).

Performers, Audiences, Competitions, Critics and Media

A growing number of new *p'ansori* artists now consider themselves to be a *ttorang kwangdae*. The word *ttorang* means a small stream or ditch and *kwangdae* stands for an entertainer or performer, hence *ttorang kwangdae* means a small-time *p'ansori* performer. In fact, traditional *p'ansori* terminology informs us about different types of *p'ansori* artists depending on their specialty and personal background. *Sori kwangdae* (literally, song performer) refers to a *p'ansori* singer with excellent voice and musical talent, while an *aniri kwangdae* (dialogue performer) is fluent in *p'ansori* narration and acting rather than the singing. *Pigabi kwangdae* (outsider performer) is a *p'ansori* artist who came from outside the traditional hereditary family of musicians and *hwach'o kwangdae* (flower performer) refers to a singer with good looks but little talent.

From a traditional point of view, *ttorang kwangdae* is a singer who does not belong to any of the major *p'ansori* schools or proper lineage of style. A *ttorang kwangdae* may be able to entertain his or her local audience but never would be able to attain the status of a fully fledged professional artist. Then why do these new *p'ansori* artists choose to identify themselves as *ttorang kwangdae* regardless of this negative image and marginal position in the world of *p'ansori*?

Perhaps Im Chin-t'aek and Yi Kyu-ho, who were renowned for their political new *p'ansori* in the 1980s, are the first kind of this self-appointed *ttorang kwangdae*. Neither of them came from a traditional *p'ansori* school although they learned from some *p'ansori* masters from such musical lineage. For them *p'ansori* performance was a form of political resistance and a cultural expression of the radical, urban, educated young people of the 1980s. Some new *p'ansori* artists in the twenty-first century come from a non-*p'ansori* background such as drama, literature, dance, and popular music. However, young *p'ansori* singers in their twenties and thirties, who are well equipped in both the traditional and modern education systems, have also joined this group of self-professed *ttorang kwangdae*. These musicians began their training from a

http://www.dorang.org
http://cafe.daum.net/NewAgePansori

제4회 도랑광대 콘테스트

판! 판! 판! 판에 살고 판에 노네!
주책바가지라도 좋다, 실명난 판에서 살아다오!

제4회 도랑광대 콘테스트가 전주한옥생활체험관에서
그 실명난 판을 펼칩니다.

도랑광대 콘테스트???

도랑광대
도랑광대는 도랑과 광대가 합해진 말인데, 도랑은 동네의 실개천을 말하는 것이고,
광대는 하늘처럼 넓고 땅처럼 크다는 말이다.

지금의 도랑광대는 판의 대중화를 목적으로 새판소리, 판농음, 판농림을 지향하는 광대를 말한다.

도랑광대 콘테스트는 2001년도 제1회를 시작으로 어느덧 네번째를 맞이하게 되었다.
제1회 때 센세이션을 일으켰던 '스타대전 저그로반 러시대목' (사설, 작창 : 박태오)
'슈퍼대 시종대회 출전기' (사설, 작창 : 김명자)
그리고 판소리는 하나도 못하면서 그리 사람들을 즐겁게 해주었던
화가 조해준의 '번번하여라'를 기억하는가?

제2회 때 어린이와 어른이 함께 기뻐한 동화판소리가 대거 등장하였다.
'토끼와 거북이' (바닥소리 공동창작) 그리고 '햇님 달님' (사설, 작창 : 류수곤)

제3회 때 동물계의 유감없는 도랑판을 기억하는가?
'복치는 걸' (박해경)과 '구라구라 애프리스'의 이상현
여성문제를 정면으로 다룬 이 사람의 '구지가'
로드판소리 정대호의 '몽치이야기' 등

회를 거듭할수록 오늘날의 시대정신을 판에서 회복하는 '도랑광대 콘테스트!!!'
과연 올해는 어떠한 이야기가 나올 것인가???
생각할수록 흥분되고 기대되는 제4회 도랑광대 콘테스트!!!
기대하시라 기대하시라!!!

일시 : 2004년 10월 2일 오후 2시부터 끝날때까지
(전주 잡늬 : 당일 전주를 떠나는 년, 늬들은 죄다-- 죽여 버린당~~~)
장소 : 전주한옥생활체험관 (리베라호텔 후문 뒤)

참가자격 : 누구나
참가작품 : 판을 살릴수있는, 그리고 시대를 담을 수 있는 그 어떤 것도 좋으며, 작품 제한시간은 10분 내외
참가비 지급 : 모든 참가자에게 상금과 참가비를 보태어 150,000원을 지급함

상금과 상품 : 관객 환호상 1명 (대상, 상장 및 소리북 1 의 부상)
전주 시장상 1명 (우수상, 상장 및 소리북 1 의 부상)
대통령상 1명 (장려상, 상장 및 부상)

심사방식 : 심사에 의한 경연방식
심사방식 : 전문가 심사 50%,
객석심사 50% (10명 내외, 심사를 원하시는 분은 '주모'를 찾으세요. 신청하면 누구나 심사 가능합니다. 선착순!)

주최 : 전주산조예술계 후원 : 063-285-7338, 016-744-1654

FIGURE 3. Poster of the fourth Ttorang Kwangdae Contest, 2004. (Photo: Courtesy of Olssigu Ttorang Kwangdae [Bravo Ttorang Kwangdae] website, <http://cafe.daum.net/NewAgePansori>)

very early age, with traditional masters, or human treasures in *p'ansori*, and then they completed their BA and MA degrees in Korean music. Some of them also became lecturers in the universities as well.³¹

It is inevitable that the personal and artistic background of the new *p'ansori* artists will influence their performance and creative products. For example, Kim Myōng-ja's *Mrs. Super's Wrestling Match* displays her theatrical talent and her ability to improvise her performance *in situ*. On the other hand, Kim Su-mi's acclaimed *I Am Crazy* (*Nanūn Ttorairisoida*), based on Yi Woe-su's poem, reflects her professional competence as an accomplished singer and researcher. Pak T'ae-o shows both musical and theatrical talent in his award winning new *p'ansori* *Star Wars*, which was originally composed as part of his final year requirement for a BA degree in *p'ansori*. The shifting tempo and pace is borrowed from the battle scene of the traditional *p'ansori* *The Song of Red Cliff*, which he studied with various master singers (Pak T'ae-o 2006).³² In the excerpts below, the tempo builds up to the battle scene in the following sequence of alternating narrations and songs: the prologue, Song 1 in the moderate *chungmori* rhythm, narration, Song 2 in the fast *chajinmori* rhythm, narration, Song 3 in the moderately fast *chungjungmori* rhythm, narration, and Song 4 in the fast *chajinmori* rhythm. Additionally, the second half of Song 1, in which the Overlord sings about his reluctance to go, "Where should I go?" is in the *menarijo* melodic type which, in traditional *p'ansori*, is used to describe a person from the lower class and/or a frivolous character, such as a servant, an unfaithful woman, or a cunning old man. The language used in the excerpt below is predominantly contemporary Chōlla dialect but it also includes some Japanese accent and English words.

An Excerpt from *Star Wars* performed by Pak T'ae-o

PROLOGUE: It is May 2002. Protoss, played by Mr. Ssūmekkiri from the country on the other side of the sea [Japan], and Zerg, played by our uncle from the local internet café, are about to start a long and bloody battle at the Lost Temple on the battle.net. (*Protoss and Zerg are two of the main "races" from this computer game.*) They exchange greetings first: "It is my pleasure to meet you" (*Mr. Ssūmekkiri, speaking with a Japanese accent*). "Yeah, it is really good to meet you, too" (*Uncle, speaking with a Chōlla accent*). Then they start the game right away.

SONG 1: (*Moderate chungmori rhythm; kyemyōnjo mode and menari melodic type*)

Our Uncle sends out Queen Zerg's Overlord in the two o'clock direction to patrol,

He then takes the Drones from the hatchery.
 The Overlord sighs as he leaves to patrol,
 "Where should I go; where should I go?
 Which direction should I take?
 Shall I go this way, or shall I go that way?
 I will encounter the enemies on my way anyway.
Ögiyadiya, let's go.
 Let's go and find the enemies."

NARRATION: After the Overlord was sent out to patrol, Queen Zerg summons the Drone. "Tell me. Drone, where is our army at the moment?"

"Yes, your Majesty, we are in the twelve o'clock position." Everyone is busy like this . . .

SONG 2: (*Fast chajinmori rhythm; kyemyönjo mode*)

The Overlord comes back from his patrol.
 He rushes back [and says]
 "I found Protoss exactly in the two o'clock position!"
 At that moment one Spawning Pool is just completed.
 "You, Drone. Collect the money. Collect the money.
 It is the rush in the early game!"³³

NARRATION: In this way Queen Zerg made the money and selects the Zerglings from the hatchery. "You, the Zergling troupe. Listen carefully. You enter the enemy's base and kill only the laborers. The second troupes will follow you. Do you understand?"

"Yes, your Majesty!" The Zergling troupe from the rush in the early game run over to the enemy and rejoice.

SONG 3: (*Moderately fast chungjungmori rhythm and kyemyönjo mode*)

"Let's hurry, let's hurry,
 Let's hurry, let's hurry.
 If we kill many of our enemies
 And perform well,
 Our Queen will reward us.
 Let's hurry, let's hurry."

NARRATION: At that time, Mr. Ssümekiri at the two o'clock position encouraged his Drones to form a gateway and display the Canons. When he is attacked by the Zerglings, he doesn't know what to do.

SONG 3: (*Fast chajinmori rhythm, kyemyönjo mode*)

When one Probe came to the front the base,
 he gets attacked by Zerg all of a sudden.
 He shouts (*in English*),

“Our post [is] under attack!”
 The Zerglings hesitate for a moment.
 But they enter one by one and launch the attack from all sides.
 “You go and destroy the Positions.
 You go and block the Zealot.
 You go and look out for the Canons,
 And then destroy all the enemy laborers!”
 Following the orders that came like this.
 Six Zerglings launch their attack all together.
 They jump on this one,
 They jump on that one,
 Just about when everyone is finished off. (*Onomatopoeia of*
canons shooting)
Ppiung, kwang, ppiung, ppyong ppyong ppyong!
 “What is this noise?”
 “General, they are the Canons!”
 “What?”
 When the Zerglings hear that the Canons are there,
 They tremble with all their body
 “What are you waiting for?
 Attack the Canons!”
 He [Mr. Ssūmekkiri] keeps shouting like this.
 The poor Zerglings have to keep coming in,
 Only to get shot by the Canons.
 They get shot as they come,
 They get shot as they go,
 They get shot while they crawl,
 They get shot while they stand, . . .
 They get shot while pleading
 “Aigo, my General, I am not even two minutes old!”
 One leader from the laborers finally says,
 “Aigo, you, laborers!
 Move over, move over there.
 Let’s destroy some Canons.
 Oh, it doesn’t work.
 Let’s retreat!”
 (Ttorang Kkangdae 2003: Track 1 [*Star Wars*, performed by
 Pak T’ae-o])

The recent proliferation of new *p’ansori* and the association of the term *ttorang kwangdae* with creativity and innovation are closely linked the emergence of several new *p’ansori* competitions. The Ttorang Kkangdae Contest organized by the Chŏnju Sanjo Festival

Committee in Chŏlla Province in 2001 was the first of this kind. This contest included three criteria: (1) a performance of any text in the *p'ansori* style, (2) a performance of a traditional *p'ansori* piece in any non-*p'ansori* style, and (3) a performance of a newly created *p'ansori* piece. Unlike the main stream *p'ansori* competitions such as Chŏnju Taesasŭp Nori (Chŏnju Festival) and Chŏnguk *P'ansori* Myŏngch'ang Taehoe (National *P'ansori* Singing Contest), which have an official jury comprised of *p'ansori* singers, scholars, and government officials, the performers at the Ttorang Kkangdae Contest are judged by both the jury and the audience. Integration and interaction between the performers and audience members are very important in this event, and eating and drinking during performance encouraged. Therefore, there is no stage or podium that separates performers, jury, and audience members from each other (see Figure 4), to create a communicative performance space of *p'an*—a concept similar to Victor Turner's (1969: 96) term *communitas*.

Another new *p'ansori* contest Ch'angjak P'ansori Sasŭp (New



FIGURE 4. A Scene from the third Ttorang Kwangdae Contest, 2003. Kim Myŏng-ja performing her joint first prize winning *Super Mazinger Daughter-in-Law*, a satire about the hardships of Korean women. The title (borrowed from the 1970s Japanese animation *Mazinger*) describes how the daughter-in-law carries out demanding domestic chores. (Photo: Courtesy of Nam Sin-hŭi, posted on 29 September 2003, <http://www.jeonlado.com/v2/ch03.html?&number=6131>)

P'ansori Contest), organized by the Chŏnju Sori Festival Committee, began in 2003. This competition is also open to any *p'ansori* piece that does not belong to the traditional five-*p'ansori* repertoire, and is judged by an official jury. The Korean National Theatre also started another new *p'ansori* competition in 2005.

While the position of jurors and judging criteria in new *p'ansori* competitions are still evolving, the mass media, especially the state run Korean Broadcasting System (KBS), has been playing a very important role in the promotion of new *p'ansori*. For example, KBS 1 TV commissioned a new *p'ansori* concert and subsequently produced a CD titled *Five Pieces of New P'ansori* in June 2004. The Gugak [Kugak] FM radio station, which has broadcast traditional and contemporary Korean music in Seoul (FM 99.1 Mhz) and Namwŏn, South Chŏlla Province (FM 95.9 Mhz) since 2001, has also featured new *p'ansori* on many occasions. Additionally, various culture centers and life-long learning institutions, which are often run by mass media, began to offer a short-term courses and workshops in new *p'ansori* for school children and adults. The participants learn about basic principles of *p'ansori* and then learn to compose and sing their own piece from some of the well-known new *p'ansori* artists. By the end of these courses, according to their advertisements, everyone would have understood and experienced some essence of Korean culture and could be a creator and performer of new *p'ansori* in their own right.

The growing number of new *p'ansori* competitions, media exposure, and some modest commercial enterprise combine to help new *p'ansori* secure its place in the Korean performing arts world and culture industry. This popularization of new *p'ansori* as a cultural commodity raises several questions that relate to the polemics of *p'ansori* aesthetics and the authenticity debate. These important issues are described below.

Aesthetics and the Authenticity Debate

A group of new *p'ansori* artists formed the National League of Ttorang Kwangdae on 13 February 2004 and made the following declaration:

The purpose of our league is to regain the spirit and life of *p'ansori* as a living art. . . . *P'ansori*, which used to speak for the masses, is now so detached from the life of the people it has become fossilised. . . . In order for *p'ansori* to be revived as a live and living art form, it is imperative that *p'ansori* speaks about our modern time and way of life. . . . We *ttorang kwangdae*, as progressive artists, will initiate this task of creating and disseminating *p'ansori* art that continues to be relevant to

our changing world. (Declaration of Ttorang Kwangdae: <http://cafe.daum.net/NewAgePansori>, accessed May 2004)

These new *p'ansori* artists clearly take the view that traditional art should be relevant to contemporary social conditions. Such artistic endeavors, to bridge tradition and modernity in the performing arts, can also be found in other Asian theatres. For example, Wenwei Du observed that the adaptations of Yuan plays in the 1990s blend “historicity and contemporaneity” (Du 2001). In the case of the West Sumatran *randai*, according to Latrell, this quintessentially conservative genre has changed itself to accommodate new global influences (Latrell 1999).

Additionally, some aspects of the guiding principles stated in the declaration of Ttorang Kwangdae resonate with the ethos of the 1980s *minjung* movement initiated by young, urban, educated cultural activists and artists. The creative energy of this 1980s phenomenon was expressed through a nationalist vision of the revival of Korean tradition, with a focus on the folk art forms as grass roots and their sociocultural significance (Wells 1995).

The declaration of Ttorang Kwangdae is also a form of protest against the formalisation of *p'ansori* into a static stage art (Pak Hŭng-ju 2003). This transformation in *p'ansori*, or a “fossilization” as referred to in the declaration, began in 1964 with the state cultural policy to preserve and promote “national intangible cultural assets.” This policy, rooted in cultural nationalism, also constructs a notion of “authenticity” that has been defined and endorsed by the state and cultural elite. For more discussion of cultural politics in Korea in relation to this state policy, see Yang Jongsung (Yang Chong-sŭng) (1998). Through this official patronage, traditional *p'ansori* has been endowed with a social and artistic distinction and newfound status as a “high” art form. In other words, this social and artistic distinction of traditional *p'ansori* is generated in a process, which Bourdieu (1990) termed *habitus* or “systems of dispositions” associated with art. When operated by state patronage in promotion of cultural nationalism, the aesthetic disposition of *p'ansori* itself also becomes an institution. While traditional *p'ansori* reaffirms its authenticity as a vocal art (*sori*, singing), the new *p'ansori* of the *ttorang kwangdae* aspires to *communitas* (*p'an*, place where people gather together) and for these new artists the ultimate aesthetic goal of *p'ansori* is to serve the masses as traditional *p'ansori* in eighteenth-century Korea was deemed to have.

While new *p'ansori* is gaining popularity among young urban audiences, not everyone supports this new art form. For example, some *p'ansori* singers express their concern that the musicality of new *p'ansori* is neglected at the expense of literary content and theatrical effect.

It [new *p'ansori*] is an imitation not a proper *p'ansori*. Every *p'ansori* artist, even a *ttorang kwangdae*, should be able to sing well because singing is the most important element in this art form. It is not possible to expect everyone to love traditional *p'ansori*, particularly a performance of the entire story [*wanch'ang*]³⁴ which takes so long. It is also understandable that some audiences nowadays like new *p'ansori* because it is easy and entertaining. But it is just a 'wannabe,' not a real thing. So we should not be won over by it. (Pak Song-hŭi [*p'ansori* singer], cited in Kim Ki-hyŏng 2004:17)

Others take this critique further and suggest that new *p'ansori* is merely a "popular entertainment" and not an authentic art form (Song 2003). This particular brand of authenticity disclaimer is derived from the notion that only the past can prescribe the conditions for contemporary folk music, while popular music is characterized by, for example, a known composer, a recent composition, association with diverse and urban social functions, and transmission by the mass media (see Bohlman 1988: 11). All these features associated with popular music are to be found in new *p'ansori*. However, this does not necessarily mean that traditional *p'ansori* itself has been completely free from the modern influences of mediatization.

While new *p'ansori* offers a fresh interpretation of a traditional performing art in modernity, the technical standard of their composition and performance do not always meet the professional level. Some of the new *p'ansori* singers have not acquired the *sŏngŭm* (literally, sound) of *p'ansori* and, therefore, their voice may still sound "untrained." In fact, to become a fully fledged *p'ansori* singer, it is necessary to go through a demanding period of vocal training over a number of years to reach the stage of *tŭgŭm* (literally, an achieving voice or sound, a high standard of singing). From the traditional point of view, both innate musicality and acquired musicality are considered important, although the latter is often more esteemed.

Although some writers are positive about the current developments in new *p'ansori* and even call *ttorang kwangdae* "the delightful rebels of *p'ansori*" (*p'ansori ūi yukwoehan idana*) (Yun 2003), others express more cautious points of view. Ch'oe Tong-hyŏn (1994), for example, considered the new *p'ansori* of the twentieth century to be transitory because it failed to be integrated into traditional *p'ansori* through its mechanism of oral transmission. This appraisal of new *p'ansori* was perhaps premature: Im Chin-t'aek's new *p'ansori* with Kim Chi-ha's narrative poem, *The Sea of Excrement*, which was created in the 1980s, has been passed down to Yi Kyu-ho, who, in turn, recreated it as *The Sea of Excrement, The Bush Version* (*Ttongbada Bush Bŏjŏn*) in 2003 to satirize the US president George W. Bush and the war in Iraq (Yi Kyu-ho 2003).

Creativity, Technology, and Community

In traditional *p'ansori* individual artists are rarely accredited as the composer or creator. Their creative input is normally only acknowledged as an originator of melodies, style, and school, all of which fall under the umbrella concept of *che* (literally, system). For example, the Kwon Sam-dŭk melody (*Kwon Sam-dŭk che*), the Kim Se-jong style (*Kim Se-jong che*), the Tongch'o School (Tongch'o *che*), and so on. The aesthetic genre rules of *p'ansori* were formed through the collective and accumulative creativity of many musicians. Designation as a national intangible cultural asset in 1964 canonized the five *p'ansori* pieces as the official repertoire of this genre.

In the case of new *p'ansori*, the creators (composer, lyricist, arranger) are always acknowledged. Originality of themes and materials used for each composition is regarded as an essential criterion for new *p'ansori*. Indeed, many *p'ansori* pieces of the last century were composed by the performer her/himself. At the same time, some of the creative work has been undertaken collectively in the context of new *p'ansori* study/performance groups. These groups are organised by *p'ansori* artists (mostly in their twenties and thirties), scholars (thirties and older), and fans/connoisseurs (from their teens to forties). Each new *p'ansori* group has a different membership profile with specific artistic and intellectual goals and interests, although some individuals may participate in more than one group.³⁵

All of the new *p'ansori* study/performance groups maintain their own websites, which they use as a platform for their discussion, exchange of audio-visual materials, recruitment of new members, and announcement of their performance events and seminars. For example, the public lecture series, organized by the Ttorang Kwangdae League, invited guest speakers to give seminars on various aspects of theory and practice associated with new *p'ansori* making. The core members of the new *p'ansori* groups bring together the virtual community on the Internet with the real community through workshops, seminars, performance events, and other associated social activities.

While they use modern technology such as the Internet extensively, many new *p'ansori* singers also give free street performances in Insadong, Seoul. A performance group called Insadong Kōrisorip'an (Insadong Street Stage for *P'ansori*) initiated a series of Sunday afternoon outdoor events in 2002 (<http://cafe.daum.net/gurisoripan>).³⁶ The intention was to "re-create" the traditional *p'ansori* "stage" in market places, thus reclaiming its *authenticity* as a performance that communicates with a wide range of the community (see Figure 5). Another study/performance group Padak Sori aims to reach out to those who



FIGURE 5. Singer Ch'ae Su-jŏng (standing) and drummer Cho Chŏng-nae (seated) performing on the street of Insadong, Seoul, on Sunday afternoon, 11 May 2003. (Photo: Courtesy of Insadong Korisorip'an [Insadong Street Stage for P'ansori] website, <http://cafe.daum.net/gurisoripan>)

are marginalized in today's Korean society. For example, they regularly visit the nursing homes for the former comfort women who were forced to serve Japanese soldiers during World War II and perform for these elderly ladies (Ch'oe Yong-sŏk 2006).

Balancing the Importance of Past, Present, and Future

Since its eighteenth-century birth, *p'ansori* has evolved from a humble outdoor folk entertainment to concert hall music with its status of national and UNESCO intangible asset representing the artistic and cultural heritage of the Korean nation. It has been nearly a century since the first new *p'ansori* piece, *The Song of Ch'oe Pyŏng-du* (1904), based on a real event, was staged as a political commentary on social injustice in a feudal and disintegrating Korea. This new *p'ansori* heralded the closure of the old world and the inevitable advancement of modernity and Japanese colonialism. Nationalist zeal during the post-colonial period prompted the creation of patriotic new *p'ansori* (*yŏl-saga*), which soon suffered the ideological conflict that split Korea into

the capitalist south and communist north. In many respects, the second half of the twentieth century was a period in which Korean modern nationhood was very much in the making. In this identity formation process, cultural memory of historical past played an important role. Traditional *p'ansori*, in this context of the construction and representation of Korean identity, embodies cultural authenticity as it informs of social and moral values of bygone days, hence its importance of the past. Perhaps it is not surprising that many of the new *p'ansori* pieces in the twentieth century were leaning toward historical, religious, and sociopolitical topics with didactic messages. Although they had new texts, the musical contents and performance style were still faithful to the traditional roots.

While making use of the traditional techniques, new *p'ansori* in the new millennium has introduced fresh influences into all of its components, namely text, music, costumes, and performance style. Elements of popular culture (both Western and Korean) and visual and theatrical displays are the most important recent additions to new *p'ansori* expression. This enculturation process also grafts modernity to traditional *p'ansori* roots. Contemporary new *p'ansori* artists come from different backgrounds and have been trained in both traditional and modern education systems, affording diverse performance styles and creative outputs.

The new interpretation of the term *ttorang kwangdae* (small-time and nonmainstream performer) is particularly noteworthy (see Pak Hŭng-ju 2006). This term, once associated with marginality and periphery, is now used as a self-identification marker by many new *p'ansori* artists and a means of resistance against the totalizing cultural expression imposed by an institutionalised tradition. Does this self-defined marginality allow individual freedom for artists to explore their creativity? Do performers now consider that tradition is no longer to be reserved for preservation and, hence, tradition and creativity are now compatible with each other?

Some new *p'ansori* artists consider traditional *p'ansori* to have become too institutionalized with its aesthetic concerns focused mainly on the singing or *sori* (production). They then argue that the shared aesthetics experienced through performance or *p'an* (consumption/reception) should be brought back to achieve an equilibrium that is the very essence of *p'ansori*. In order for new *p'ansori* to communicate with its audience, they stress, it should also include contemporary themes that are relevant to everyday experience.

In fact, everyday life in twenty-first-century Korea is full of syncretism, ranging from the living environment, clothes, food, music, and so on in which mixtures of tradition and modernity are continu-

ously reconfigured. Syncretism, fusion, and hybridity are creative tactics of contemporary artists to explore new ideas and materials. Notably, creativity itself seems to be perceived as being part of everyday life in Korea and it has even become a commodity. The various new *p'ansori* workshops and courses are designed to teach the participants how to be creative, but at a cost; the courses are not free. In other words, the participants become active consumers of packaged creativity that is authenticated by the culture industry.

Since the turn of the twentieth century, technology has increasingly influenced all aspects of *p'ansori*. Technology is now not only the tool for production and consumption but it can also be the creative material employed as an element of *p'ansori* narrative. The extensive use of the Internet has also become the hallmark of the contemporary *p'ansori* scene in which various study groups and audience members create both virtual and real communities.

Although newly composed *p'ansori* is nearly a hundred years old, the rapid increase in new *p'ansori* performances, artists, audiences, agents, and contexts are all very recent. In fact, many of these new *p'ansori* artists are still young and training to become fully fledged professionals. It is perhaps too soon to predict where all these creative energies will lead. But one thing we could deduce from the dynamics of *p'ansori* development in modernity is that tradition and creativity are not only compatible with each other but inspire and give new life to artistic expression.

NOTES

1. This article owes much to the many individual *p'ansori* artists and performance groups who generously gave their assistance and support. Above all, my special thanks should go to the members of the Ttorang Kwangdae League, Insadong Korisorip'an, and Padak Sori groups. I am also very grateful to the anonymous reviewers whose comments were invaluable to the revision of this article.

Korean terms referred to in this article in italics are romanized according to the McCune-Reischauer system.

2. This article focuses on new *p'ansori* created in Korea and performed in the Korean language. Transnational *p'ansori* and *p'ansori*-derived genres to be found amongst the Korean diaspora in China and the former USSR are discussed elsewhere (Um 2002a). Park Chan E. (Pak Ch'an-ŭng) has developed an English version of *p'ansori* in the United States primarily for non-Korean speaking audiences. She discusses the creative processes of her English *p'ansori* in her book (Park 2003). New *p'ansori* artist Ch'oe Yong-sŏk and his group Padak Sori (Grass Roots *P'ansori*) have also been developing *p'ansori* in Japanese.

3. For detailed descriptions see Um (1992, 1993a, 1993b, 1994, 2002b).

4. *Cho* loosely refers to the musical mode. However, it also includes a wider range of concepts such as melodic type, mood, singing style, and ornamentation. The name of each *changdan* designates a certain type of meter, tempo, and rhythmic pattern, by which it is distinguished from all other *changdan*. For example, a basic pattern of *chungmori* (lit. moderate drive) consists of twelve beats (12/4) with the accent on the ninth beat, while *chajinmori* (lit. fast drive) comprises four fast beats with three subdivisions in each beat (12/8).

5. For example, the *kyemyŏnjo* mode is used for songs describing scenes of sorrow or desperation. When combined with the slowest rhythmic cycle, this feeling of sorrow is intensified, and when combined with a fast rhythmic cycle, it describes an extremely urgent and/or desperate situation. The *ujo* mode is usually combined with the slow rhythmic cycle to describe a majestic scene or a heroic figure while the *p'yongjo* mode, in combination with a rhythmic cycle in moderate tempo, is associated with peaceful scenes and a cheerful mood.

6. Korean Royal Shrine Ceremonial Music was also proclaimed as a UNESCO Masterpiece of Oral and Intangible Heritage of Humanity in 2001.

7. The piece titled "The Rabbit Story" in her 1995 experimental collaboration was an excerpt from the traditional *Song of the Underwater Palace* (*Sugung-ga*), while "Longing for Shim Ch'ong" and "Astounded" in her 1996 recording were taken from *The Song of Simch'ŏng* (*Simch'ŏng-ga*) and *The Song of Hŭngbo* (*Hŭngbo-ga*) respectively. See the discography for the albums *Nanjang: A New Horizon* (1995), and *West End* (1996).

8. The piece Yi Cha-ram and OneSun collaborated on is called '*Ŏbusa* (*The Ode of a Fisherman*). This title was taken from a poem by Kosan Yun Sŏn-do (1587–1671), which, in turn, inspired by the work of Nongam Yi Hyŏn-bo (1467–1555) who wrote poetry in classical Chinese. Both of these poems took themes from the Chinese scholar Qu Yuan (Sino-Korean pronunciation Kur-wŏn) (circa 343–277 BCE).

9. These are all forms affected by *p'ansori*. *Sanjo* is a solo instrumental music accompanied by the hourglass drum, or *changgo*. It originated from the folk music of the southwestern province of Korea. The invention of this genre is generally attributed to Kim Ch'ang-jo (1865–1918). *Kayagŭm pyŏngch'ang* (lit. a voice together with *kayagŭm* twelve-stringed zither) was presented by a singer playing a *kayagŭm* while sitting on the floor with the instrument across his or her knees. *Ch'anggyŏk* (lit. sung drama) in its earliest form was kept simple, with several singers performing each role, without any costume or setting except for a white curtain as background. Costumes, stage setting, and orchestral accompaniment, as well as dance and chorus came into this performing art later.

10. Pak Tong-sil was born into a family of musicians in Tamyang, South Chŏlla province. He learnt *p'ansori* from his father, Pak Chang-wŏn, and maternal grandfather, Pae Hŭi-gon, and began his singing career from his teens. He moved to North Korea shortly after the Korean Civil War (1950–1953). In P'yŏngyang he taught and created musical theatre productions. He

was awarded the title of People's Artist in 1961 (Kim Tök-kyun et al. 1998: 259–260).

11. These four were all important nationalists. Yi Chun (1858–1907) and two other envoys, Yi Sang-söl (1870–1917) and Yi Wi-jong (1887–?), were sent to the Second Hague Peace Convention in 1907 by King Kojong of Korea to submit a petition in protest of the Japanese attempt to colonize Korea. But the convention ruled that King Kojong was no longer sovereign over Korean foreign affairs. Yi Chun died in the Hague.

An Chung-gŭn (1869–1910) assassinated Itô Hirobumi, the first Japanese resident-general of Korea, at Harbin railway station in Manchuria on 26 October 1909. An was arrested and executed in prison on 26 March 1910.

Yun Pong-gil (1908–1932) threw the bomb at the celebration of the Japanese emperor's birthday in Hungkou Park in Shanghai on 29 April 1932 and was executed in Osaka on 19 December in the same year.

Yu Kwan-sun (1902–1920) participated in the street demonstration for national self-determination, also known as the “March First Independence Movement,” in 1919, which, in turn, was prompted by Woodrow Wilson's proposal of Fourteen Points at the 1918 Versailles Peace Conference. She also organized a series of independence protests in her hometown Ch'önan. She died in prison in Seoul in 1920 at the age of eighteen.

12. Yi Söng-gŭn learnt the patriotic new *p'ansori* pieces from the late singer/drummer Kim Tong-jun (1928–1990) while Chöng Sun-im learned the patriotic new *p'ansori* *The Tale of Yu Kwan-sun* (*Yu Kwan-sun-jön*) from her late mother and versatile artist Chang Wölchungsön (1925–1998). In their joint recording, Yi Söng-gŭn performs three pieces, *The Song of Yi Chun*, *The Song of An Chung-gŭn*, and *The Song of Yun Pong-gil*, all of which are rather short, each piece lasting approximately twenty, twelve, and fifteen minutes respectively. The three stories are also chronologically linked up with one another. For example, the ending of the first piece, *The Song of Yi Chun*, is summarized briefly in the prologue of the second piece, *The Song of An Chung-gŭn*, which, in turn, runs into the third piece, *The Song of Yun Pong-gil*. In this respect, they are more like episodes rather than complete stories on their own. On the other hand, *The Song of Yu Kwan-sun*, performed by Chöng Sun-im, is a complete life story and lasts about an hour and ten minutes.

13. Chöng Ch'öl-ho was born into a family of traditional performing artists in Hanam, South Chölla province. He is better known for his *p'ansori* theatre works than new *p'ansori*. He is also credited with the development of *ajaeng sanjo*, the solo instrumental music for the bowed zither *ajaeng*.

14. Kim Tae-gön Andrea (1821–1846) was born in Tangjin, South Ch'unch'öng province. In 1836 he was sent to Macau by the French missionary Maubant to train as a priest. He was ordained in China in 1845 and returned to Korea in the same year. He was arrested and executed in 1846 as his faith and mission were regarded both as a threat and treason to the then Confucian state of Korea. He was declared a saint by the Vatican in 1984.

15. Won Buddhism was founded in 1916 by Pak Chung-bin (1891–1943), who was born in Yönggwang, South Chölla province. Established in the twentieth century while Korea was under Japanese occupation, this sect has a

strong tendency toward pragmatism in combination with traditionalism and nationalism.

16. An Suk-sŏn's Buddhist *p'ansori* was recorded in 2001 and has been circulated mainly on Buddhist websites such as "Buddha Land Music Hall" <http://www.sambori.com>.

17. Im Chin-t'aek began his *p'ansori* training with the mastersinger Chŏng Kwŏn-jin (1927–1985) in the 1970s while he was studying international politics at Seoul National University.

18. This piece uses the poem *The History of a Sound* (*Sori Naeryŏk*), which originally was the first part of Kim Chi-ha's narrative poem *Groundless Rumour* (*Piŏ*) written in 1972.

19. Im Chin T'aek's work employs the narrative poem *The Tale of Mr. Excrement* (*Punssi Murŏ*), which was written by Kim Chi-ha in 1974. This poem is a comical and grotesque sketch about a Japanese man named Mr. Excrement, who ravages the Korean Peninsular with the help of political establishment of Korea and subsequently drowns in his own excrement. It was banned at the time because of this implied criticism of the then ruling classes.

The Five Bandits (*Ojŏk*) was written in 1970 and appeared in the May issue of the monthly magazine *The Realm of Ideology* (*Sasanggye*) in the same year. It was Kim Chi-ha's first narrative poem (*tamsi*) to employ the traditional *p'ansori* style of rhetoric and form. This poem satirized social injustice and corruption in parody of the five politicians who signed the treaty of 1905 that relinquished Korea's foreign affairs to Japan. Kim Chi-ha was arrested and imprisoned for two years for his "crimes" under the terms of the anti-Communist legislation of South Korea. The publication of Kim Chi-ha's poem also led to the closure of the journal *Sasanggye* that started in 1953 and produced 205 issues before it was shut down.

20. Pak Chŏng-hŭi (1917–1979) was born in Kumi, South Kyŏngsang province, into a poor farming family. After his training in the Japanese military academy in Manchuria he became an officer in the Japanese army in North-east China. He returned to Korea in 1946 and joined the newly established army of the Republic of Korea. He became a general in 1953 and came to power when he led the military revolution in 1961. He was elected as the fifth president of the Republic of Korea in 1963. He served five terms as president in total until 1979 when he was assassinated.

21. This civil uprising began on 18 May 1980 when some five hundred people took to the streets of Kwangju, demanding the repeal of martial law. Elite paratroopers landed in the city and began an indiscriminate attack on anyone who was in their way. By 21 May, hundreds of thousands of local civilians joined in to drive away the soldiers. The local citizen's council appealed to the US embassy to intervene without effect and on 27 May the Twentieth Division of the Republic of the Korean Army entered Kwangju and took over the city by force. The exact number of casualties is not known to this day. It is only possible to surmise the enormity of the brutality from the fact that Kwangju's death statistics soared in May 1980 from its monthly average of 2,300 to 4,900 (Cumings 1997: 377–378).

22. Although most new *p'ansori* have been composed or arranged by

p'ansori singers, there are some exceptions. For example, in 1976 Cho Chae-sŏn wrote, in a specially devised three-line notation, *Prince Hamyŏl (Hamyŏl T'aeja)*, which was taken from Shakespeare's *Hamlet*. In the same year, Hwang Pyŏng-gi wrote *The Tale of Nolbu (Nolbu-jŏn)*, based on a Korean modern novel written by Ch'oe In-hun (Um 1992).

23. In the excerpt given, there are a number of rhymes in the Korean which sometime overlap with epiphora: the word *naonda* (is coming) is an example of epiphora. Asyndeta are normally found in songs performed in a fast tempo, in which a number of nouns are strung together without any conjunctions: this excerpt lists various personal belongings made of gold. The Korean word *kkulkkŏk* is an example of onomatopoeia and imitates the gulping or swallowing sound. As examples of mimesis, the Korean word *nallŭm* depicts the motion of putting something into the mouth very fast while the words *tiruk tiruk* and *pulluk pulluk* depict the shape that is wobbly and bulging respectively. An example of metaphor is *kuwŏsamta* (literally, to roast and boil) which in this context means "to persuade" or "to bribe."

24. For example, religion continued to provide themes and motives for new *p'ansori* in this century Korea. In 2001 Kim Hyŏng-chŏl performed *The Tale of Moses (Mose-dyŏn)* based on the Old Testament, and in 2004 Wang Ki-ch'ŏl (b. 1963) performed the Mass *p'ansori (Misa p'ansori)*, which combines *p'ansori* singing with the Kyrie, Gloria, Agnus Dei, Credo, Sanctus, and Benedictus from the Catholic high liturgy.

25. For example, Yi Cha-ram's *The Song of Planet Kuji (Kugji-ga)* critiques gender inequality in contemporary Korea through a satirical tale about a planet where women dominate and men are subordinate. (The word *kuji* is an inversion of *chigu*, the Earth. Everything on planet Kuji is opposite to Earth.)

26. This work won the first prize at the first Chŏnju New P'ansori Competition (Ch'angjak P'ansori Sasŭp) in 2003.

27. *The Rabbit and Turtle* was composed in collaboration by the members of the new *p'ansori* group Padak Sori (Grass Roots P'ansori). It won the first prize at the second Ttorang Kwangdae New P'ansori Contest in 2002. *The Sun and the Moon* was composed by Yu Su-gon, who used to be a rock musician. It won the third prize at the second Ttorang Kwangdae New P'ansori Contest in 2002.

28. This new *p'ansori* piece is a folktale about a Chinese Korean village in Jilin Province. Kim Su-mi composed its music. See the discography.

29. This new *p'ansori* was performed by the eleven-year-old *p'ansori* singer Kim Hae-ram (b. 1993). The text was written by Kim Ŭn-gyŏng and music was composed by Pak Ae-ri.

30. Since the normalization of Chinese and South Korean diplomatic relations in 1992, the number of Chinese Koreans entering South Korea to visit or work has been steadily increasing. It is estimated that there are over 130,000 Chinese Koreans currently staying in the country, of whom 91,736 are officially registered with the South Korean authorities. Several "Chinese Korean towns" or *Chosŏnjok tongp'o t'aun* have grown in southwestern Seoul. See Chin Chong-ho (2003).

31. In the 1980s some universities and colleges in South Korea created

a BA degree program in *p'ansori* performance, specializing in the singing first and the drumming some years later. About a hundred *p'ansori* performers with a BA degree are produced each year. See Ch'ae Su-jöng (2000) for a discussion on the transmission and consumption of *p'ansori* in contemporary Korea.

32. Also see Yi Kyu-ho (2004) for his discussion of compositional techniques employed in some of the new *p'ansori* pieces produced between 2001 and 2003.

33. In the jargon of this computer game, “rush” is equivalent to a game advantage.

34. Pak Tong-jin (1916–2003) began to give *wanch'ang* (literally, complete singing) performances in the late 1960s. His 1968 performance of *The Song of Hūngbo* took five hours, and *The Song of Ch'unhyang* in the following year lasted for eight hours. He then went on to give the *wanch'ang* performance of all of the other pieces of the traditional *p'ansori* repertoire. His new *p'ansori* piece *The Tale of Admiral Yi Sun-sin* (*Ch'ungmugong Yi Sun-sin-jön*) lasted a record nine hours and forty minutes. By the mid 1970s, this way of performing a whole *p'ansori* story became a standard practice and the most appropriate way for a singer to become fully accepted as a professional by both other musicians and the general public.

35. For example, the core members of Sori Yöse (Let's Open P'ansori) are academically trained professional singers who perform both traditional and new *p'ansori* (<http://cafe.daum.net/unfurl>) (Kim Su-mi 2003) while P'anse (P'ansori World) is an amateur and fan-based study group (<http://cafe.daum.net/panse>). T'aru (Ornaments, <http://www.taroo.com>) has a company-like structure and produces new *p'ansori* musical productions (Yi Cha-ram 2003), and Padak Sori (Grass Roots P'ansori, <http://cafe.daum.net/badaksori> and <http://www.badaksori.com>) promotes new *p'ansori* for the masses (Ch'oe Yong-sök 2006). Insadong Kōri Sorip'an (Insadong Street Stage for *P'ansori*, <http://cafe.daum.net/gurisoripan>), Olssigu Ttongrang Kwangdae (Bravo Ttorang Kwangdae, <http://cafe.daum.net/NewAgePansori>) and Ttorang Kwangdae (<http://www.dorang.org>) are all run by the key members of the Ttorang Kwangdae League (Kim Myöng-ja 2006).

36. Insadong in central Seoul is lined with antique stores, art galleries, and bookshops, and the street becomes an outdoor performance venue when traffic is diverted on Sunday. Since the beginning of 2005 these Insadong street performances became less frequent and the performance venue moved to different locations.

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